Table of Contents

1 Overview 2

2 The Election Process 2

2.1 Elections Process Diagram 3
2.2 Elections 3
2.3 The Ballot 3
2.4 Annual General Meeting 4
2.5 Election Schedule 4
2.6 Elections Committee 4

3 Voter Registration & Eligibility 4

3.1 Voter Eligibility 4
3.2 Voter Registration 4

4 Candidate Eligibility 5

4.1 Candidate Requirements 5
4.2 Term of Office 5
4.3 Conflict of Interest 5

5 Nomination of Candidates 6

5.1 Nomination Request 6
5.2 Nomination Announcement 6
5.3 Present Candidates 6

6 Balloting Procedures 6

6.1 Physical Ballot 6
6.1.1 Secret Ballot 6
6.1.2 Public Ballot 6
6.2 Electronic Ballot 7
6.3 Proxy 7
6.4 Hybrid 7
6.5 Acclamation 7

7 Tabulating Votes 7

7.1 Counting ballots 7
7.2 Tabulation of Results 7
7.3 Announcement of Results 8
7.4 Appeal Process 8

8 Bylaws 8

A. References 9

1 Overview

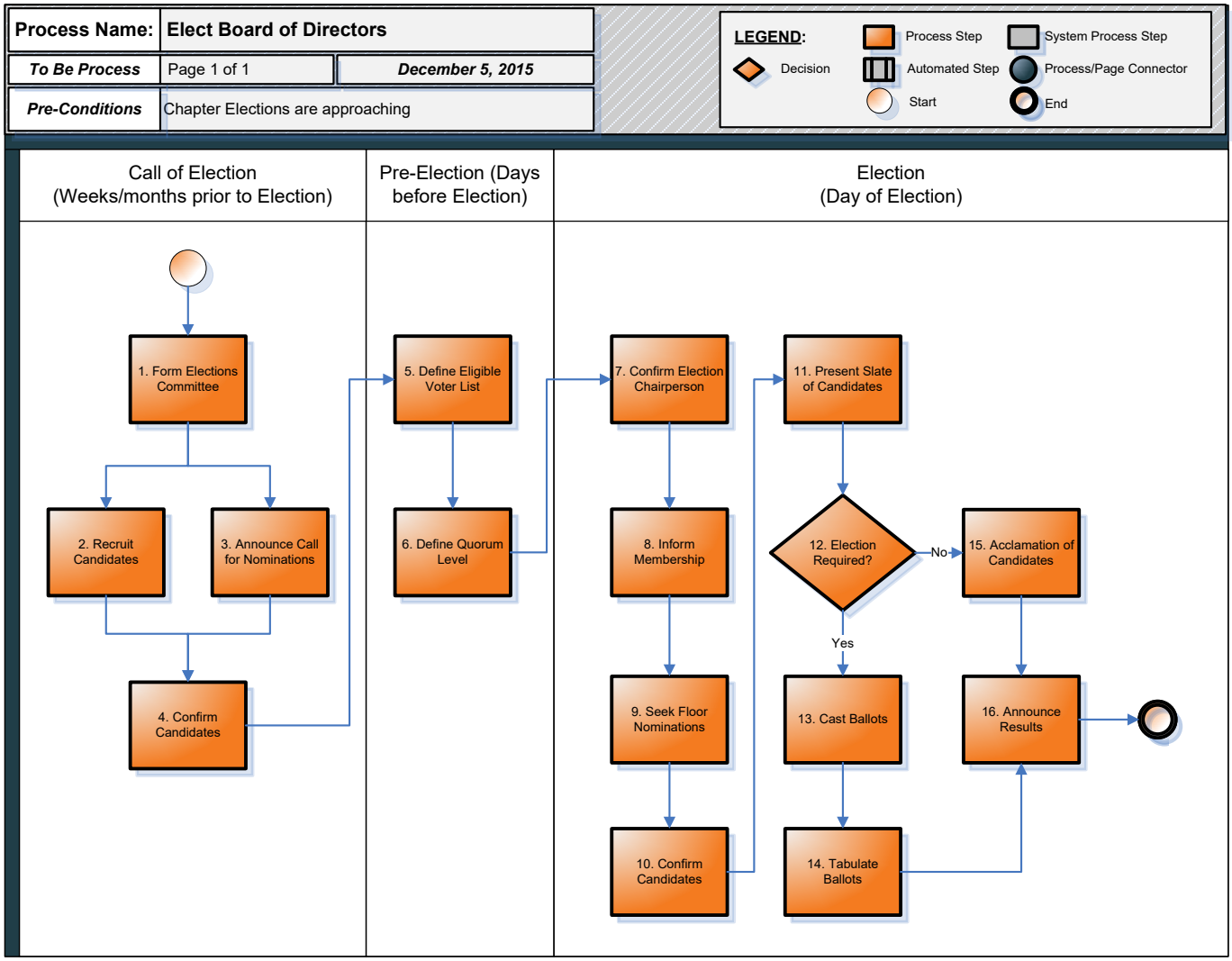
International Institute of Business Analysis™ (IIBA®) has over 100 Chapters worldwide with elected Board of Directors [Board], made up of Volunteers, who direct and manage these individual Chapters. As a membership organization, it is necessary for Chapters to conduct elections to give its membership a voice in the programs and future strategic direction of the Chapter.

This document lays out a framework for Chapters to use in conducting elections for positions on its Board. It should not be considered a mandate (Chapters are free to define their election process and procedures as they see fit), nor does it prescribe the ideal election process. Rather, it describes best practices to guide Chapters in conducting elections of its Board of Directors Members (Leaders) in the most honest, methodical, and transparent way possible. The purpose is not to standardize election processes, procedures, or calendar schedule amongst all Chapters; but rather help ensure Chapters have reflectively developed and documented those processes, procedures, and schedule for themselves.

2 The Election Process

The election process consists of a schedule, eligibility to vote, eligibility to hold office, nominations, slate of candidates, terms of office, balloting, tabulating votes, and announcement of new Leaders. All these components should be defined within the Chapter Bylaws. Below you will find guidance in helping define these components of the election process.

2.1 Elections Process Diagram



2.2 Elections

Elections are the formal process IIBA Chapters use to determine who manages and governs the Chapter in the form of the Board. In this document the term “election” refers to the decision-making process of Chapter Members to choose an individual or set of individuals to hold a position on the Board. It includes both contested (more than one nominee) and uncontested (single nominee) decisions.

2.3 The Ballot

Whether using a private, electronic or hybrid balloting process, a ballot must be used to present the candidates for office to the membership for voting. The ballot will list each office up for election and each candidate running for each office.

2.4 Annual General Meeting

Hold elections in conjunction with an Annual General Meeting (AGM) rather than adding additional administrative meetings to Members' schedules. Elections should take place at the end of the AGM so that the meeting can conclude before new Leaders assume their roles.

In a purely electronic balloting process, the AGM can be used to announce new Leaders, if balloting was conducted and closed prior to this meeting. As an alternative, the AGM can be used to announce the opening of elections, when elections will close, and when new Leaders will be announced to the membership.

2.5 Election Schedule

Stagger elections so there is never a complete change of the Board in a given year. In addition:

- Have two-year terms of office for Board positions
- Elect one half of the Board every year
- Determine which Board positions are elected in even numbered years, and which are elected in odd numbered years
- Elect the President and VP of Finance in opposite years

2.6 Elections Committee

Run elections under the direction of an Elections Committee who operate under the guidance of the Board but in an independent manner. Election Committee Members are not permitted to seek office but are to act as independent advisors and facilitators for the elections process. Their sole mandate is to ensure the seamless election of Board Leaders through a transparent and unbiased process.

3 Voter Registration & Eligibility

3.1 Voter Eligibility

A voter must meet certain requirements to be eligible to cast their vote. The Chapter shall define those requirements, but at the minimum they must be a Member in good standing (active IIBA membership).

3.2 Voter Registration

Prior to opening of balloting, a register of potential voters must be drawn up and include all Members that are eligible to vote based on Chapter requirements. Only Members on this register are permitted to vote.

Each eligible voter should only be able cast one vote, and ineligible voters should not be able to cast any vote.

4 Candidate Eligibility

To hold office on the Board, candidates must meet the defined eligibility requirements. Requirements for candidacy need to make sense for your Board but not be so demanding that potential candidates are deterred.

4.1 Candidate Requirements

Candidates must be Members in good standing of IIBA and meet all the requirements for the position they seek. Other requirements are:

- Board of Director candidates should be affiliated with the Chapter for a specified period prior to elections
- Presidential candidates should have held another position on the Board prior to running for President

4.2 Term of Office

To attract candidates and have continuity on the Board, an effective term of office is two years. However, the Chapter can determine if Leaders are eligible to serve multiple terms. Electing one half of the Board each year allows second-year Leaders to remain on the Board to help on-board and welcome new Leaders. Chapter Members also become accustomed to yearly elections.

4.3 Conflict of Interest

Chapter Leaders must avoid situations where personal interests could conflict, or appear to conflict, with duties and responsibilities or the interests of the Chapter. A conflict of interest may occur where involvement in any activity, with or without the involvement of a related party, prevents the proper performance of the Leader's duties for the Chapter, or creates, or appears to create, a situation where judgment or ability to act in the best interests of the Chapter is affected.

Some examples of conflicts of interest that would be unacceptable include (but are not limited to):

- The candidate is a close relative of another Leader
- The candidate is from the same company as an existing Leader
- The candidate is a Leader of another organization with a similar mission and program structure
- The candidate's job or activity is naturally, or perceived to be, in conflict with the interests of the Chapter

If the conflict of interest presents an obstacle for the candidate to fulfill the duty of loyalty to the Board, it is necessary to re-evaluate their candidacy.

5 Nomination of Candidates

5.1 Nomination Request

Candidate nominations should be conducted two to three months prior to the start of balloting, although recruitment of potential candidates can begin at any time and should be a year-round effort to ensure that there is at least one candidate for each office up for election.

The Chapter will determine if candidates may nominate themselves or if they must receive nomination from another Member of the Chapter. If candidates do not nominate themselves, they must be asked if they accept the nomination and intend to run for office. If they do not accept the nomination, then other candidate(s) for the position must be found.

Once nominated, nomination accepted (if needed) and eligibility to seek office confirmed, the candidates for each Board position are added to the election slate, which is prepared by the Elections Committee.

5.2 Nomination Announcement

Prior to the election, the slate of nominated candidates is announced to Chapter Members.

5.3 Present Candidates

To give Members the opportunity to make an informed voting decision, once nominations have been closed, have all candidates introduce themselves to the Members and describe what they will bring to the position.

6 Balloting Procedures

Once the slate of candidates has been finalized and announced, the balloting may begin. There are a number of balloting options.

6.1 Physical Ballot

A physical ballot requires voters to be present during the election and can be accomplished through secret or public ballot. The advantage of physical balloting is that it is done in a much shorter time period, voters do not have to identify themselves on the ballot, and it usually returns a higher rate of balloting. It is important to establish quorum if using this method.

6.1.1 Secret Ballot

Through paper ballots, each eligible voter casts their vote for the candidate in each position up for election. This requires pre-election planning in that paper ballots must be created and made available only to eligible voters.

6.1.2 Public Ballot

Voters use a show of hands to cast their vote, and the Elections Committee simply counts the number of people who have raised their hand (voted) for the candidate. While this is the easiest method of voting, it should be noted that with large groups, it is possible for some people to vote more than once, and ineligible voters may get their vote counted.

6.2 Electronic Ballot

There are many electronic balloting tools available for election of Board Members. Some Chapters have successfully used Survey Monkey, Election Buddy, Smartmatic, Simplyvoting, Electronic-vote and several other tools. The link to the electronic ballot is sent out to all eligible voters and notes the deadline for voting.

The advantage of electronic balloting is that Members do not have to attend a specific meeting or have someone else cast their ballot via proxy and meeting time does not have to be set aside to hold elections. However, electronic balloting may cause the election process to be drawn out over time and voters may have to identify themselves on the ballot for verification of eligibility.

6.3 Proxy

Chapters will need to determine whether they will allow proxy votes, where eligible voters can delegate their voting rights to another eligible voter. The process usually involves a signed letter from the eligible voter indicating who will vote on their behalf.

6.4 Hybrid

Chapters may choose to use a combination of the procedures from this section. The most widely used hybrid procedure would be a physical ballot with proxies. However, there is nothing stopping a Chapter from using physical and electronic ballots for the purpose of reaching all their Members. Be aware however, that as a Chapter introduces more forms of balloting, the process of validation becomes more complex.

6.5 Acclamation

In some instances, if there is only one candidate for a position, the candidate is considered elected by acclamation. This is considered best practice as the process is easiest.

7 Tabulating Votes

Once all the votes have been collected, the Elections Committee must tabulate the votes for each position. Access to the voting results information during the voting and tabulation of votes period should be limited to the Members of the Elections Committee.

7.1 Counting ballots

The Elections Committee reviews each ballot and validates that the number of ballots is appropriate for the number of eligible voters. In physical balloting, the number of ballots must be equal to or less than the total number of eligible voters present and the number of proxy votes. In electronic balloting or hybrid method, the number of ballots must be equal to or less than the total number of eligible voters in the Chapter.

7.2 Tabulation of Results

Once the ballots have been counted, the number of ballots for each candidate for each position is tabulated. The candidate with the most votes is determined to be the winner.

7.3 Announcement of Results

After results have been tabulated, the winner for each of the positions is announced to Members and to the candidates. The Board publicly welcomes the newly elected and thanks everyone for participating in the election process.

7.4 Appeal Process

The Chapter should define an appeal process to deal with any objections to the election process. Objections to the election process may come from candidates or eligible voters; handling both objections must be defined in the appeal process. Typically, the Elections Committee has the final say in any appeal.

8 Bylaws

In order to facilitate the elections process, the Chapter should clearly articulate the election process in the Chapter Bylaws and define the following:

- Positions on the Board of Directors
- Duties of the Leaders on the Board of Directors
- Eligibility to hold office on the Board of Directors
- Process to waive candidate eligibility requirements (in cases where only candidate wishing to run for a particular office does not meet those requirements)
- Terms of office
- Term limits; the number of consecutive terms that a person may hold the same office
- Action taken when a person exceeds term limits and there is no candidate wishing to run for the office
- Duties of the Elections Committee during the election process
- Eligibility to serve on the Elections Committee
- Date that newly elected Leaders officially take office
- Eligibility to vote
- Election schedule
- Voting quorum; number of votes that must be cast in order for the election to be valid
- Meeting quorum; number of Members required to be in attendance for a physical vote
- Action to be taken when voting or meeting quorum is not met
- Action taken should a position become vacant between scheduled elections
- Use of proxies in the election process
- Elections appeals process
- Process for resignations
- Process for removals

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